



Nothing Happens For Decades, Then...

A large number of consumers are more open and ready to test new products or ideas. Businesses must use this opportunity to innovate and test them; the time could not be more conducive than now



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I hope the title reminds you of a famous quote from Lenin.

“There are decades where nothing happens, and there are weeks where decades happen.”—Vladimir Ilyich Lenin (1917)

This month marks the first anniversary of one such week of the last year. The disruption was certainly unwarranted (the word says it all) and unplanned for. However, it highlighted several flaws in our ecosystem at several levels.

It highlighted how our ways of doing work have many pressure points. How several things that we do daily could fall apart by just changing its medium, for example, meeting virtually instead of in-person. And why we must be agile, resilient, and well prepared at all times.

Nonetheless, it has already happened! So, what happens now? What comes after disruption?

The disruption cycle

Before we discuss the disruption cycle, please note that it is not the same as hype-cycle info-

graphics popularised by Gartner. Hype-cycle mainly highlights trends and their relative place in the overall hype-cycle. On the other hand, the disruption cycle can be seen as a real phenomenon that repeats cyclically in our economy.

For example, think about what happened in 2008-09 during the global financial crisis (GFC). And most importantly, what was happening a few years before GFC and a few years after that. Especially after the crisis, several new small businesses sprung-up, and most of them today are significantly larger, making their mark in the ecosystem.

Every disruption, planned or unplanned, always stirs the market and displaces norms. When that happens, people get creative as there is nothing or little to lose. It results in them taking actions that, otherwise, were not possible. People take chances and play with their ideas, bring them to life.

Essentially, it is clear that innovation is almost always the usual outcome of these disruptions.

Innovation is almost always the usual